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Subject: Waterproofing System – Sump Pumps and Battery Backup

1 message

Nicholas Scarr <nscarr@quantlogic.com> 19 December 2025 at 17:31
To: Andy Lyne <Andy.Lyne@qlaims.com>
Cc: Claims <Claims@qlaims.com>, Louisa Scarr <scarrlouisa@gmail.com>

Dear Andy,

I'm writing to clarify the necessity and function of the sump pump systems and battery backup specified within the proposed waterproofing scheme for 1 Riverside Cottages, and to confirm their inclusion within the waterproofing design as reflected in the **MacLennan quotation**, with associated builder's works addressed in the **Silks quotation**.

Due to the property's construction — including earth-retaining walls, raised external ground levels, and underlying clay subsoil — the structure is subject to persistent **hydrostatic pressure** and perched groundwater. This creates a foreseeable risk of water ingress at slab joints and wall–floor interfaces, particularly following rainfall or infrastructure failure, as occurred during the **February 2025 flooding event**.

The MacLennan proposal specifies:

- An **internal Hydrosump-Pro** to manage water collected behind the internal cavity drain membrane (Type C protection);
- An **external Hydrosump-Pro** to relieve water build-up around the structure, particularly at the rear terrace threshold.

Because flood events often coincide with power failure — notably in this case due to Southern Water's pumping station malfunction — the design also includes **battery backup systems (Victron inverter + dual battery banks)**. These ensure continued pump operation during mains outages.

This configuration complies with **BS 8102:2022**, which requires drained systems to remain functional under foreseeable conditions, including power loss (Clause 9.2.3). Duty and backup pumps, high-level alarms, and battery-supported operation are all standard requirements for resilient protection in such environments.

The Silks quotation has been prepared following detailed discussions with MacLennan and reflects the builder-side works required to support delivery of the waterproofing system as specified.

Please find attached both the MacLennan and Silks quotations for reference.

To summarise: the sump pumps and battery backup are **not discretionary**. They are essential elements of a BS-compliant waterproofing strategy, addressing known risks at this property. Their inclusion is necessary to ensure the system performs as designed under both normal and adverse conditions.

Kind regards,
Nicholas

Let me know if you'd like a PDF version or formatted cover note to accompany the attachments.

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2 attachments

1 Riverside Cottages REVV Quote 30114 (1).pdf
1108K

Quote QU2730 (2).pdf
75K